

The Bauhaus

Architect Walter Gropius (1883–1969) founded the Bauhaus School of Art, Craft and Design in Weimar, Germany in 1919. Aiming to unify art, craft and technology, Gropius developed a curriculum that would produce artisans and designers able to create useful and beautiful objects. It began with a preliminary course teaching the basic elements and principles of design and colour theory, and practical work. Students then specialized in disciplines of their choice. The system became adopted by art and design schools across the world.

Teachers included Gropius, Johannes Itten (1888–1967), Oskar Schlemmer (1888-1943), Kandinsky, van Doesburg, El Lissitzky and László Moholy-Nagy (1895–1946). In 1923, the Bauhaus adopted the slogan 'Art into Industry', and in 1925, moved to Dessau, where Gropius designed a building with many features that later became characteristic of Modernist architecture. In 1928, Hannes Meyer (1889–1954) became director, and from 1930 to 1933, Ludwig Mies van der Rohe (1886–1969) led the school.



Schlemmer, *Bauhaus Stairway*, 1932